Indonesian Government & Intelligence Secrets: Parapsychic Warfare, State Mysticism, and Occult Operations

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Subject: The Intersection of Indonesian Statecraft, Military/Intelligence Agencies (BAKIN/BIN, Opsus, Kopassus, Hankam), Presidential Regimes, and the Supernatural/Parapsychic Realm.

1. Cosmological Foundation: "Wahyu Praja" and Power in the Indonesian Mind

To understand why the Indonesian government, intelligence apparatus, and armed forces have historically engaged with the spiritual and parapsychic realms, one must understand the traditional Indonesian (particularly Javanese) concept of power (*Kasekten*):

- **Secular vs. Sacred Power:** Unlike Western political theories where power is an abstract legal construct derived from popular mandate or institutional law, traditional Javanese statecraft views power as a tangible, quantifiable, and cosmic energy (*Kasekten*) that concentrates in individuals who successfully conduct ascetic disciplines (*tapa brata*, *tirakat*, *prihatin*).
- **Wahyu (The Divine Mandate):** Political legitimacy is determined by the possession of *Wahyu Cakraningrat* or *Wahyu Makutharama* (the divine radiance/celestial spark). If a leader loses their *wahyu*, their regime collapses inevitably, regardless of constitutional safeguards or military firepower.
- **Pusaka (Sacred Heirlooms):** Material vessels—such as keris, spears, royal carriages, and talismans—are believed to anchor cosmic spiritual energy to physical dynasties. Control of sacred heirlooms (*pusaka*) equals control of the realm.

This foundational mindset did not disappear with the declaration of the Republic in 1945; instead, it was institutionalized covertly within presidential inner circles, intelligence agencies, and elite military units.

2. Sukarno Era (1945–1967): Mysticism of the Founding Father

President Sukarno presented himself to the international community as a modernist revolutionary, anti-imperialist, and Marxist-nationalist thinker. Internally, however, Sukarno's leadership was deeply rooted in Indonesian spiritual syncretism:

2.1. The Commander's Baton (*Tongkat Komando*)

- **Material & Origin:** Sukarno possessed several batons, but his primary *Tongkat Komando* was carved from *Kayu Pucang Kalak* (wood from the Kalak region near Pacitan, East Java).
- **The Legend & Function:** In Javanese lore, *Kayu Pucang Kalak* contains an intrinsic natural repellent against poisonous reptiles and mystical shields against malevolent sorcery (*santet*). Sukarno famously carried it everywhere—to state visits, bilateral summits with Eisenhower and Khrushchev, and public rallies.
- **Psychological & Protective Aura:** Sukarno himself humorously dismissed claims that the baton made him magical, yet he never appeared publicly without it. Intelligence and diplomatic dispatches from Western embassies noted that both domestic allies and rivals believed the baton contained his *wibawa* (unquestioned authority) and physical invulnerability (*kekebalan*).

2.2. Miraculous Assassination Survivals (*Ilmu Lembu Sekilan*)

During his presidency, Sukarno survived at least seven well-documented direct assassination attempts:

1. **Granat Cikini (November 30, 1957):** Grenades were thrown at Sukarno outside the Perguruan Cikini school in Jakarta; dozens of schoolchildren and bystanders were killed or maimed, but Sukarno escaped without a scratch.
2. **Strafe Serangan MiG-17 Daniel Maukar (March 9, 1960):** An Indonesian Air Force pilot aligned with the Permesta rebellion strafed the Merdeka Palace with 23mm autocannons; Sukarno had just vacated the presidential desk moments prior to the cannon shells shredding his chair.
3. **Idul Adha Shooting (May 14, 1962):** A shooter from the Darul Islam extremist movement fired at Sukarno from a distance of barely seven meters during prayer at the palace courtyard; the shooter testified that as he aimed, he suddenly saw multiple identical visions of Sukarno and could not focus his weapon.

- **The Cultural Consequence:** These continuous, inexplicable survivals cemented among the Indonesian public and military the conviction that Bung Karno possessed high-level esoteric protection (*Ajian Lembu Sekilan* or *Pancasona*).

2.3. The South Sea Goddess (*Kanjeng Ratu Kidul*) & Samudera Beach Hotel

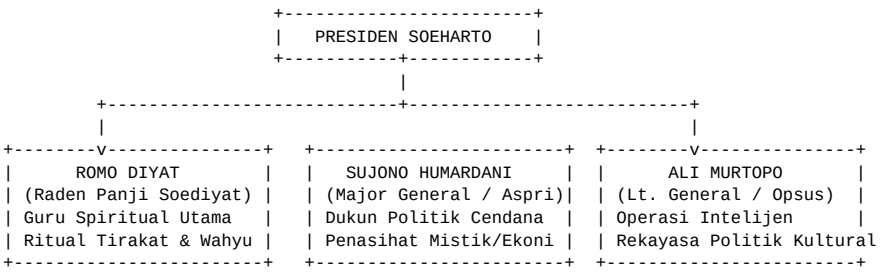
- **The Mataram Pact:** In Javanese royal tradition, the ruler of Java must maintain a spiritual marriage/covenant with *Kanjeng Ratu Kidul*, the mythical Queen of the Southern Ocean, to ensure territorial stability.
- **Room 308, Samudera Beach Hotel (Pelabuhan Ratu):** In the early 1960s, Sukarno used Japanese war reparations funds to build several luxury state hotels, including the Samudera Beach Hotel in Pelabuhan Ratu (West Java). By explicit presidential order, **Room 308** was permanently reserved and decorated in sacred green silks exclusively for *Kanjeng Ratu Kidul*. To this day, Room 308 remains a state-acknowledged mystical sanctuary where offerings, prayers, and meditations are conducted by officials, military officers, and spiritual pilgrims.

3. Soeharto & The New Order (1966–1998): Institutionalized State Mysticism

If Sukarno's mysticism was romantic and charismatic, President Soeharto's mysticism was **systematic, bureaucratic, and deeply integrated into intelligence operations**.

3.1. The Inner Spiritual Troika

Soeharto surrounded himself with a closed circle of spiritual advisors and covert operators who directly influenced state policy:



1. **Romo Diyat (Raden Panji Soediyat Prawirokoesoemo):**

- Soeharto's primary spiritual master (*guru kebatinan*) since his days as commander of the Diponegoro Division in Central Java.
- Romo Diyat guided Soeharto through complex ascetic rituals (*kungkum*—meditating submerged in river junctions, and *ngalong*—hanging upside down or fasting in dark caves).
- Prior to the pivotal March 11, 1966 transfer of power (*Supersemar*), Romo Diyat reportedly prophesied to Soeharto that the *Wahyu Cakraningrat* had abandoned Sukarno and was hovering above Soeharto, ordering him to seize the leadership of the nation.

2. **Major General Sujono Humardani:**

- Served as the Presidential Assistant for Economic Affairs (Aspri), but in reality was Soeharto's chief spiritual curator and liaison to occult masters across Java and Bali.
- Foreign ambassadors, including U.S. diplomats, privately dubbed him *"the White House Witch Doctor"* or *"Rasputin of Cendana"*.
- Humardani maintained a dedicated room filled with ancient *keris*, stone talismans, and incense. He routinely traveled across Indonesia to acquire high-grade heirlooms believed to possess protective wards to shield Cendana (the presidential family residence) from rival sorcery and political subversion.

3. **Lieutenant General Ali Murtopo & OPSUS (Special Operations):**

- Head of the feared *Opsus* (Special Operations) and later Deputy Head of BAKIN (State Intelligence Coordinating Agency).
- Murtopo brilliantly blended modern clandestine psychological warfare with traditional Javanese cultural engineering. Opsus mobilized folk groups, traditional shamans (*dukun*), and local spiritual figures to manipulate regional elections and break up Islamic political blocs.

3.2. Sacred Hermitages & Power Sanctuaries (*Situs Keramat*)

Soeharto regularly retreated to sacred power centers (*tempat petilasan*) across Java:

- **Gua Semar (Semar Cave, Dieng Plateau):** Considered the spiritual heart of Java, dedicated to Semar (the divine guardian spirit of the island). Soeharto spent nights meditating alone inside this pitch-black, sulfurous cavern.
- *The Diplomatic Dimension:* In September 1974, Soeharto took Australian Prime Minister Gough Whitlam to Gua Semar. Soeharto made Whitlam enter the cave barefoot and in traditional attire to establish a "spiritual connection" before discussing the impending geopolitical fate of Portuguese Timor. Soeharto also arranged spiritual visits for Singapore's Prime Minister Lee Kuan Yew.
- **Pertapaan Jambe Pitu (Mount Selok, Cilacap):** A cliffside sanctuary overlooking the rough waves of the Indian Ocean where Soeharto sought guidance from ancestral spirits during national crises.

- **Mount Lawu (Hargo Dumilah & Candis Cetho/Sukuh):** Believed to be the final retreat of King Brawijaya V of Majapahit. Soeharto's spiritual team regularly performed cleansing rites on Lawu to harness the spiritual authority of the fallen Majapahit Empire.
- **Astana Giribangun (Karanganyar):** Soeharto constructed his family mausoleum on the foothills of Mount Lawu, deliberately situated just below the royal tombs of the Mangkunegaran princes (Astana Mangadeg), perfectly calculated according to sacred geomancy (*feng shui* and Javanese cosmic orientation).

3.3. Legalization of Aliran Kepercayaan (GBHN 1978)

Soeharto's determination to elevate traditional mysticism culminated in a constitutional battle in 1978:

- The New Order government formally included **Aliran Kepercayaan terhadap Tuhan Yang Maha Esa** (Indigenous Javanese Mystical Faiths) into the State Policy Guidelines (GBHN) via **TAP MPR No. IV/MPR/1978**.
- This placed traditional kebatinan organizations on par with recognized world religions for administrative and cultural purposes, placed under the Ministry of Education and Culture rather than the Ministry of Religious Affairs. This move triggered an unprecedented walkout by the Islamic United Development Party (PPP) in Parliament.

4. Military & Intelligence Operations Utilizing Parapsychic Assets

Indonesian armed forces (ABRI/TNI) and intelligence services (BAKIN/BIN) have repeatedly operationalized esoteric, parapsychic, and traditional martial energy (*tenaga dalam*) in field operations:

4.1. Integration of "Tenaga Dalam" (Internal Martial Energy) in Special Forces

- **Merpati Putih (PPS Betako Merpati Putih):**
- Founded on royal Mataram heirloom techniques, Merpati Putih was officially adopted by the Indonesian Armed Forces to train elite units, including **Kopassus (Army Special Forces)**, **Taifib (Marine Reconnaissance)**, **Kopaska (Navy SEALs equivalent)**, and **Paspampres (Presidential Security Force)**.
- **Aura & Vibration Detection (*Getaran / Blindfold Sensing*):** Soldiers are trained in sensory deprivation techniques, learning to navigate obstacle courses, detect hidden steel/explosives, identify hostiles in total darkness, and disarm attackers while completely blindfolded.
- While public demonstrations are viewed as martial arts spectacles, internal military doctrine considered this an asymmetric capability for night raids, counter-terrorism, and close-quarters combat inside unlit bunkers or subterranean complexes.
- **Sin Lam Ba, Margaluyu, and Perisai Diri:**
- Various battalions routinely integrated breathing and esoteric empowerment exercises (*ilmu kebatinan kanuragan*) into recruit regimens to build extreme physical endurance, pain tolerance, and morale invulnerability.

4.2. Operasi Seroja (East Timor, 1975–1999)

- **The Jungle Warfare Paradox:** In the thick rainforests of East Timor, conventional radar and sensor technology were largely useless against FRETILIN / FALINTIL guerrilla forces.
- **Deployment of Traditional Trackers & Dukun:** Field commanders from Kopassus and Kostrad frequently embedded local traditional trackers and spiritualists into long-range reconnaissance patrols (LRRP). These individuals were tasked with using intuitive/shamanic sensing to predict ambushes, determine which trails were trapped with punji stakes or mines, and locate water sources.
- **Amulets (*Jimat*) & Battle Magic:** Soldiers across all ranks carried consecrated amulets (*rajah*, *isim*, *wifik*, or keris kecil) sewn into uniform linings or combat vests. Encounters with FALINTIL commanders (such as Nicolau Lobato and Xanana Gusmão) were frequently surrounded by military folklore claiming that enemy leaders possessed indigenous Timorese magic (*lulik*) that allowed them to vanish into thin air, requiring counter-magical neutralization.

4.3. The Mapenduma Hostage Rescue (Papua, 1996)

- **The Crisis:** In January 1996, the OPM (Free Papua Movement) under Kelly Kwalik kidnapped an international scientific research team (the Lorentz Expedition 95, including British, Dutch, and German scientists) in the remote highlands of Mapenduma.
- **The Operation:** Commanded by Brig. Gen. Prabowo Subianto (Danjen Kopassus). The military utilized state-of-the-art foreign technology, including Israeli-made unmanned aerial reconnaissance drones (UAVs) and British mercenary tracking experts.
- **The Esoteric Track:** Concurrently, Kopassus brought in traditional Dayak trackers from Borneo and local Papuan spiritual elders to conduct tracking by anomalous sensory intuition and ancestral rituals. The combination of high-tech surveillance and deep indigenous tracking enabled the military to pinpoint the hostages' moving encampment through impassable cloud-forest terrain.

4.4. The 1998 Banyuwangi Witch Hunt ("Operasi Ninja" & Dukun Santet)

- **The Incident (February–November 1998):** In the chaotic months surrounding the fall of Soeharto, a horrific wave of violence erupted in East Java (Banyuwangi, Jember, Pasuruan, Malang). Between 150 and 300 individuals were systematically hunted down, tortured, and murdered under the accusation of being *dukun santet* (black magic practitioners).
- **The "Ninja" Phenomenon:** Witnesses consistently reported that the killings were executed by highly trained squads dressed in black overalls and masks ("Ninjas"). These operatives exhibited:
- Military-grade physical agility (leaping onto rooftops, silent movement in darkness).
- Professional coordination (telephone lines and power grids were cut simultaneously before strikes).
- Escape capabilities that baffled local villagers, leading to hysterical rumors that the ninjas possessed supernatural powers to disappear into smoke or turn into animals.
- **Intelligence & Psychological Warfare Revelations:**
- Subsequent investigations by Komnas HAM, human rights groups, and the PBNU fact-finding team (led by Gus Dur) revealed that the "sorcery hunt" was a sophisticated **black psychological operation (*operasi pengondisian/pengalihan*)**.
- The real targets were often local village clerics, *Kiai*, and prayer leaders (*guru ngaji*) affiliated with Nahdlatul Ulama. The cover of "killing sorcerers" was exploited by rogue intelligence/military factions to terrorize East Java, destabilize the transition to Reformasi, and pit traditionalist Muslims against secular communities.

5. Post-Suharto Era: Modern Presidential Spiritual Traditions

The fall of the New Order did not terminate esoteric statecraft; each successive administration maintained its own spiritual practices:

5.1. Abdurrahman Wahid (Gus Dur) — Mystical Intuition & Saints (*Karamah Para Wali*)

- Gus Dur possessed an encyclopedic knowledge of Indonesian Islamic mystical genealogy (*tasawwuf* and *tariqah*).
- He frequently made major political and diplomatic decisions based on intuitive flashes (*firasat batin*) or after praying at the tombs of the *Wali Songo* and ancestral saints across Java and Madura.
- During tense political standoffs with Parliament, foreign diplomats reported with astonishment that Gus Dur would casually remark that he had consulted with long-deceased 19th-century saints regarding national stability.

5.2. Susilo Bambang Yudhoyono (SBY) — The Cikeas Supernatural Infiltration

- In his official 900-page memoir published after leaving office, *Selalu Ada Pilihan* (2014), President SBY openly documented a terrifying supernatural attack on his private residence in Cikeas:
- SBY recounted that while he and First Lady Ani Yudhoyono were resting, a thick, swirling dark cloud (*asap hitam tebal berputar-putar*) materialized inside the house and moved menacingly toward their master bedroom.
- SBY and his security aides confronted the phenomenon by reciting Quranic verses (*Ayat Kursi* and *Al-Mu'awwidhatayn*), causing the dark cloud to dissipate through the ceiling.
- This marked the first time in modern Indonesian history that an active head of state formally committed a firsthand account of surviving a *santet* (sorcery) attack to print in an autobiographical record.

5.3. Joko Widodo (Jokowi) — The "Kendi Nusantara" Cosmic Geodesy at IKN

- **Date:** March 14, 2022
- **Location:** Ground Zero (*Titik Nol*), Nusantara Capital City (IKN), East Kalimantan.
- **The Ritual:** President Jokowi summoned all 34 provincial governors from across the archipelago. Each governor was ordered to bring one kilogram of sacred soil (*tanah*) and one liter of sacred water (*air*) taken from historical or spiritually significant sites in their home provinces.
- **Cosmic Syncretism:** In a televised ceremony, Jokowi personally poured the water and soil from all 34 provinces into a giant ceremonial bronze vessel (*Gentong/Kendi Nusantara*), burying it at the exact geographical center of the new capital.
- **Symbolism:** Anthropologists and political observers recognized the ritual as a direct continuation of ancient Majapahit *Nusantara-wide* cosmic unification rites (*penyatuan tanah dan air*), spiritually sacralizing the new seat of government before physical construction commenced.

6. Official State Institutions Regulating the Supernatural

Indonesia maintains formal bureaucratic mechanisms to supervise, surveil, and legally adjudicate esoteric and mystical phenomena:

Institution	Functional Mandate over Paranormal / Esoteric Matters
Bakorpakem *(Badan Koordinasi Pengawasan Aliran Kepercayaan Masyarakat)*	Inter-agency body under the Attorney General's Office (Kejaksaan Agung) comprising BIN (State Intelligence), Polri (Police), TNI, and the Ministry of Religious Affairs. Surveils mystical sects, heterodox spiritual groups, and cults to prevent public disorder or blasphemy.
Directorate of Belief in God Almighty *(Direktorat Kepercayaan terhadap Tuhan YME, Kemendikbud)*	Civil registration and cultural preservation organ for accredited indigenous kebatinan organizations across Indonesia.
New Penal Code (KUHP Baru / UU No. 1 Tahun 2023, Pasal 252)	Formal criminalization of fraudulent or harmful sorcery: penalizes anyone who declares themselves possessing supernatural power (*ilmu gaib*) and offers services to cause illness, death, or physical suffering to others (up to 3 years imprisonment).
Polri "Labfor" & "Polda" Special Investigative Units	Law enforcement units tasked with investigating occult-related homicides, including fraudulent money-doubling shamans (*Dukun Pengganda Uang*, e.g., kasus Wowon Erawan, Dimas Kanjeng Taat Pribadi, Mbah Slamet Banjarnegara).